

Wyatt Snyder

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 Wyatt Snyder |  [wsnyder215](https://github.com/wsnyder215)

Holland, Michigan - 49423, United States

OBJECTIVE

Mathematics and Computer Science undergraduate with research interests in AI safety. Seeking research opportunities where rigorous mathematical thinking meets real computational problems.

EDUCATION

- **Hope College** August 2023 - May 2027 (expected)
Bachelor of Science in Mathematics, Bachelor of Arts in Computer Science
◦ GPA: 3.98/4.00
◦ Relevant Coursework: Advanced Linear Algebra, Algorithms, Creating A.I. in the Loop, Numerical Analysis, Statistical Methods
- **Home School** May 2022
Secondary Education
◦ GPA: 3.93/4.00 Hammond, Indiana

RESEARCH AND PROJECTS

- **Survival Analysis of Long-Term Seed Viability** April 2025 - May 2026
Advisors: Drs. Brian Yurk and Yew Meng Koh, Hope college Dept. of Math and Statistics 
 - Modeled seed viability over a 30-year field experiment across 6 species using parametric, semiparametric, and nonparametric survival models fit to interval-censored germination data
 - Derived and implemented a novel parametric survival model incorporating an initial viability parameter ν , improving fit significantly over standard exponential and Weibull models for multiple species
 - Computed closed-form Fisher information matrices and applied the Delta Method to generate simultaneous confidence bands; validated analytical derivatives numerically
 - Conducted 24 likelihood ratio tests across nested model pairs with Bonferroni correction to assess model complexity tradeoffs
- **LLM Personality Stability Experiment** March 2026 - May 2026
Tools: Lane Graph, Gemini Code Assist, Claude Sonnet 
 - Developed experimental tool for testing stability of various psychological measures in LLMs against prompt nudging
 - Implemented Lane Graph workflow for nudging and measuring specific personality traits in LLMs, resulting in an effective tool for altering and analyzing LLM personality across conversation turns
 - Created flexible framework for experimentation, ensuring a variety of methodologies can be run with the tool
 - Applied personality experimentation tool to analyze the effects of various prompts on LLM personality

SKILLS

- **Programming Languages:** Python, R, Java, Perl, C
- **Mathematical & Statistical Tools:** icenReg (Survival Analysis), MLE, Covariance

HONORS AND AWARDS

- **The Russell J. Kraay Prize** March 2026
Hope College Department of Computer Science
 - Awarded to 2 sophomore or junior students who have demonstrated excellence in Computer Science.
- **Undergraduate Research Grant** Feb 2026
Michigan Space Grant Consortium 
 - \$5,000 grant from NASA-based funding for conducting research on modeling LLM personality stability
- **Pi Mu Epsilon Outstanding Research Presentation Award** Jan 2026
Pi Mu Epsilon National Honorary Mathematics Society
 - Award for presentation given at the 2026 Joint Mathematics Meetings
- **John H. Kleinheksel Mathematics and Statistics Award for Second Year Students** Oct 2025
Hope College Department of Mathematics and Statistics

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- **Pi Mu Epsilon National Honorary Mathematics Society**, Michigan Delta Chapter Oct 2025 - Present
- **Association for Women in Mathematics**, Student chapter June 2025 - Present

EXPERIENCE

- **Hope College Academic Success Center**  Sept. 2025 - Present
Math Lab Leader
Holland, Michigan
 - Support students in 100- and 200-level mathematics courses by guiding them through homework problems, helping them develop conceptual understanding, and encouraging independent problem-solving skills.
- **Hope College Academic Success Center**  Aug 2024 - Present
Academic Tutor
Holland, Michigan
 - Aid students in comprehension and concept retention through weekly tutoring meetings
 - Courses: Discrete Math (MATH 160)- 4 students; Intro to Statistics (MATH 115)- 3 students; Exploring Computer Science (CSCI 112)- 5 students; Programming Language Paradigms (CSCI 245)- 2 students; General Biology I (BIOL 105)- 2 students
- **Hope College Digital Media Lab**  Jan 2025 - Present
Digital Media Consultant
Holland, Michigan
 - Aid students in using software available to them, including SPSS, R, jamovi, and Python
 - Provide assistance with lamination, printing, and other services to the greater Hope community

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

- **Community Volunteer** Oct 2023 - May 2026
Boys and Girls Club of Greater Holland 
 - Served as a weekly volunteer mentor for elementary and middle school students, offering academic support, participating in recreational activities, and contributing to a positive, inclusive community environment

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Interests: LessWrong, Clarinet, Yoga, Reading

REFERENCES

1. **Dr. Brian Yurk**
Kenneth G. Herrick Professor, Dept. of Mathematics and Statistics
Hope College
Email: yurk@hope.edu
Relationship: Research and Academic Advisor
2. **Dr. Aaron Cinzori**
Associate Professor, Dept. of Mathematics and Statistics
Hope College
Email: cinzori@hope.edu
Relationship: Instructor for multiple math courses
3. **Dr. Fola Olagbemi**
Assistant Professor, Dept. of Computer Science
Hope College
Email: olagbemi@hope.edu
Relationship: Research Advisor